04

Fragmentation lives between the parts

Organisations rarely fragment because individual teams fail. They fragment because growing complexity makes the connections between teams, systems and stakeholders harder to manage.

ILLUSTRATION · CONNECTIONS GROW FASTER THAN PARTS

5 TEAMS	10 TEAMS	20 TEAMS
10 possible connections	**45** possible connections	**190** possible connections

Pairs between n parts: n × (n − 1) ÷ 2. Doubling the parts roughly quadruples the relationships to manage.

As interactions increase, dependencies multiply, decision paths lengthen and coordination consumes more organisational energy. The challenge shifts from managing individual components to **managing the relationships between them.**

Fragmentation emerges when these relationships become too numerous or too dependent on continuous synchronisation.

> **Organisations rarely struggle from a lack of capability. They struggle when capability can no longer move coherently together.**
>
> WHY ENTERPRISES FRAGMENT